

Scraping Murderpedia:

ARE MEN MORE LIKELY TO USE VIOLENT METHODS
WHEN COMMITTING HOMICIDE?

Lailaa Holmes

ECO 590

Motivation

1

Interested to see behavioral differences between male and female offenders, specifically in the methods used to commit homicide.

2

Men are responsible for most homicide offenses worldwide. Women are more likely to use less direct or less physically violent methods than men (UNODC).

Variables Collected

- **Name of offender**
- **Gender: male or female**
- **Method: shooting, poisoning, stabbing, etc.**
- **Number of victims**
- **Location**
- **Violent vs. non-violent method**
- **Serial killer status**

Web Scrapping Process

Murderpedia

The Encyclopedia of Murderers

Murderpedia is a free online encyclopedic dictionary of murderers and the largest database about serial killers and mass murderers around the world..

MALE murderers

5,852 entries - 1,573 photo galleries

[index by country](#) - [index by name](#) [A](#) [B](#) [C](#) [D](#) [E](#) [F](#) [G](#) [H](#) [I](#) [J](#) [K](#) [L](#) [M](#) [N](#) [O](#) [P](#) [Q](#) [R](#) [S](#) [T](#) [U](#) [V](#) [W](#) [X](#) [Y](#) [Z](#)



FEMALE murderers

1,069 entries - 661 photo galleries

[index by country](#) - [index by name](#) [A](#) [B](#) [C](#) [D](#) [E](#) [F](#) [G](#) [H](#) [I](#) [J](#) [K](#) [L](#) [M](#) [N](#) [O](#) [P](#) [Q](#) [R](#) [S](#) [T](#) [U](#) [V](#) [W](#) [X](#) [Y](#) [Z](#)

Murderpedia has thousands of hours of work behind it. To keep creating new content, we kindly appreciate any donation you can give to help the Murderpedia project stay alive. We have many plans and enthusiasm to keep expanding and making Murderpedia a better site, but we really need your help for this.

Thank you very much in advance.

Donate



CRIMINALIA.ES
La enciclopedia del crimen
(in spanish)

Last updates **June 4, 2017**

DeathPenaltyUSA.org
The database of executions in the United States of America

Privacy Policy

```
male_url = "https://murderpedia.org/male.A/index.A.htm"
female_url = "https://murderpedia.org/female.A/index.A.htm"
male_response = requests.get(male_url, headers=headers)
female_response = requests.get(female_url, headers=headers)

male_soup = BeautifulSoup(male_response.text, "html.parser")
female_soup = BeautifulSoup(female_response.text, "html.parser")
male_response
female_response
```

[illegible]

New variable

VIOLENT VS
NONVIOLENT

```
[66]: # Creating violent vs non-violent variable

violent_methods = ["Shooting", "Stabbing", "Strangulation", "Bludgeoning/Beating", "Axe/Hatchet", "Drowning", "Burning/Fire"]

final_df["violent_vs_nonviolent"] = ["Violent" if m in violent_methods else "Non-violent" for m in final_df["method"]]

final_df[
    [
        "name",
        "gender",
        "victims",
        "location",
        "method",
        "violent_vs_nonviolent"
    ]
].head(270)
```

[66]:

	name	gender	victims	location	method	violent_vs_nonviolent
0	Burton W. ABBOTT	Male	1	California, USA	Poisoning	Non-violent
1	Jack Henry ABBOTT	Male	2	Utah/New York, USA	Stabbing	Violent
2	William Keith ABBOTT	Male	1	New Zealand	Shooting	Violent
3	Azad ABDULLAH	Male	1	Idaho, USA	Stabbing	Violent
4	Herisch Ali ABDULLAH	Male	1	Germany	Shooting	Violent
...	...	...	...	...	...	...
249	Gunn-Britt ASHFIELD	Female	1	Australia	Shooting	Violent
250	Lisl AUMAN	Female	1	Colorado, USA	Poisoning	Non-violent
251	Zakieya Latrice AVERY	Female	2	Maryland, USA	Stabbing	Violent
252	Asuncion AVILA-VILLA	Female	1	Ohio, USA	Bludgeoning/Beating	Violent

—

New variable

SERIAL
KILLER

```
•[68]: # Lastly I will be creating my second variable which identifies serial killer status
#According to the FBI a serial killer has to have 2 or more victims

# Creating serial killer variable
#Searching to see if the number or victims is 2 or more than labeling that as a Yes if it is just one then it will be a No

final_df["serial_killer"] = ["Yes" if re.search(r"\d+", str(v)) and int(re.search(r"\d+", str(v)).group()) >= 2
                             else "No"
                             for v in final_df["victims"]]

final_df[
    [
        "name",
        "gender",
        "victims",
        "location",
        "method",
        "violent_vs_nonviolent",
        "serial_killer"
    ]
].head(270)
```

[68]:

	name	gender	victims	location	method	violent_vs_nonviolent	serial_killer
0	Burton W. ABBOTT	Male	1	California, USA	Poisoning	Non-violent	No
1	Jack Henry ABBOTT	Male	2	Utah/New York, USA	Stabbing	Violent	Yes
2	William Keith ABBOTT	Male	1	New Zealand	Shooting	Violent	No
3	Azad ABDULLAH	Male	1	Idaho, USA	Stabbing	Violent	No
4	Herisch Ali ABDULLAH	Male	1	Germany	Shooting	Violent	No
...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
249	Gunn-Britt ASHFIELD	Female	1	Australia	Shooting	Violent	No

— Grouping

SERIAL
KILLER,
LOCATION, AND
GENDER

```
• [87]: #Counting to see how many serial killers and non-serial killers there are by gender and location
#edit this info
final_df["usa_location"] = ["USA" if "USA" in location else "Non-USA" for location in final_df["location"]]
# Counting serial killers by location and gender
serial_by_location = (final_df.groupby(["usa_location", "gender", "serial_killer"])["name"].count().reset_index(name="count"))

serial_by_location
#There are more serial killers in the U.S for both genders
```

[87]:

	usa_location	gender	serial_killer	count
0	Non-USA	Female	No	15
1	Non-USA	Female	Yes	5
2	Non-USA	Male	No	23
3	Non-USA	Male	Yes	33
4	USA	Female	No	20
5	USA	Female	Yes	10
6	USA	Male	No	80
7	USA	Male	Yes	68

Grouping

VICTIM,
METHOD, AND
LOCATION

```
[95]: #Grouping by location and gender and method to see if location impacts method
#But first I am going to make a USA variable since currently it shows up as states
final_df["usa_location"] = ["USA" if "USA" in location else "Non-USA" for location in final_df["location"]]

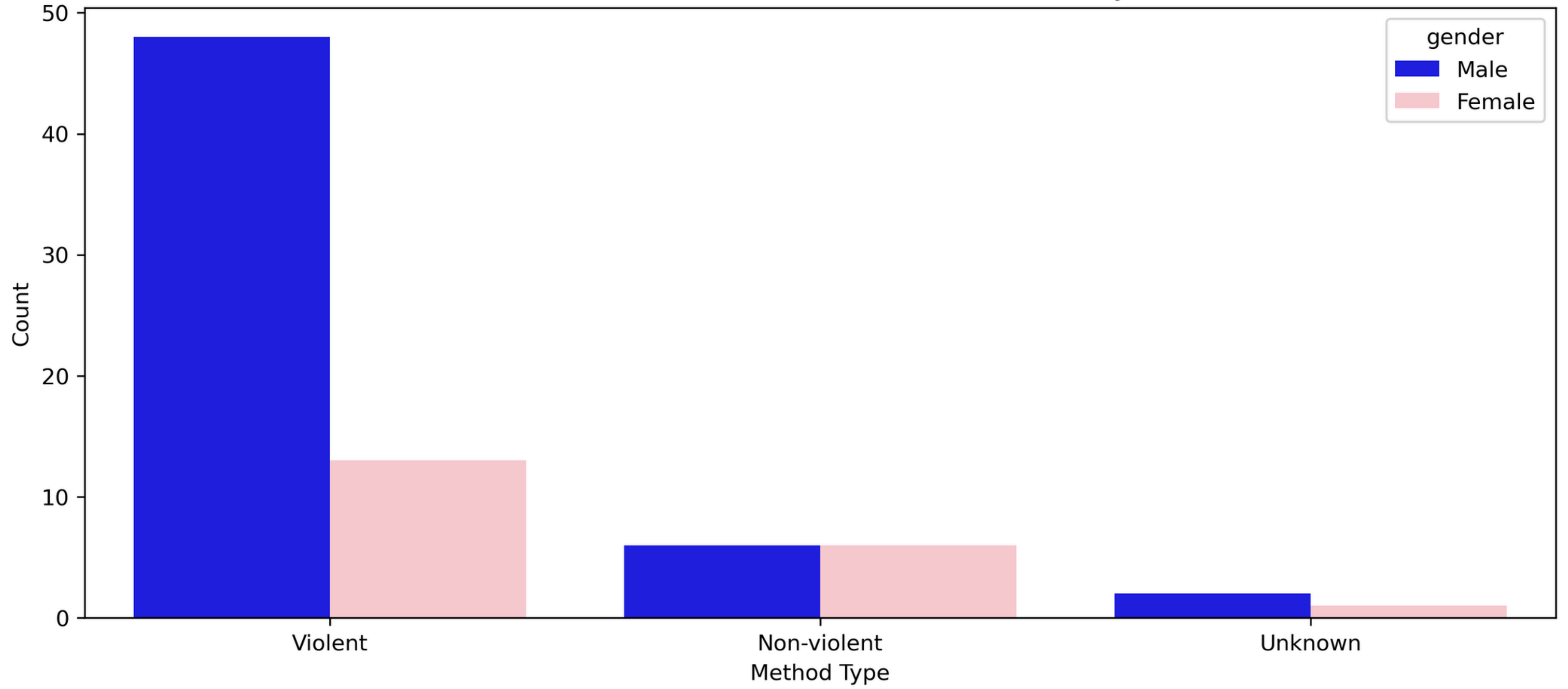
# Grouping USA vs Non-USA by gender and method type
usa_gender_method = (final_df.groupby(["usa_location", "gender", "method"]).size().reset_index(name="count"))

usa_gender_method
#For women not in the US their main method is posion while in the US it is shooting
#For maless regardless of location shooting is their main method
```

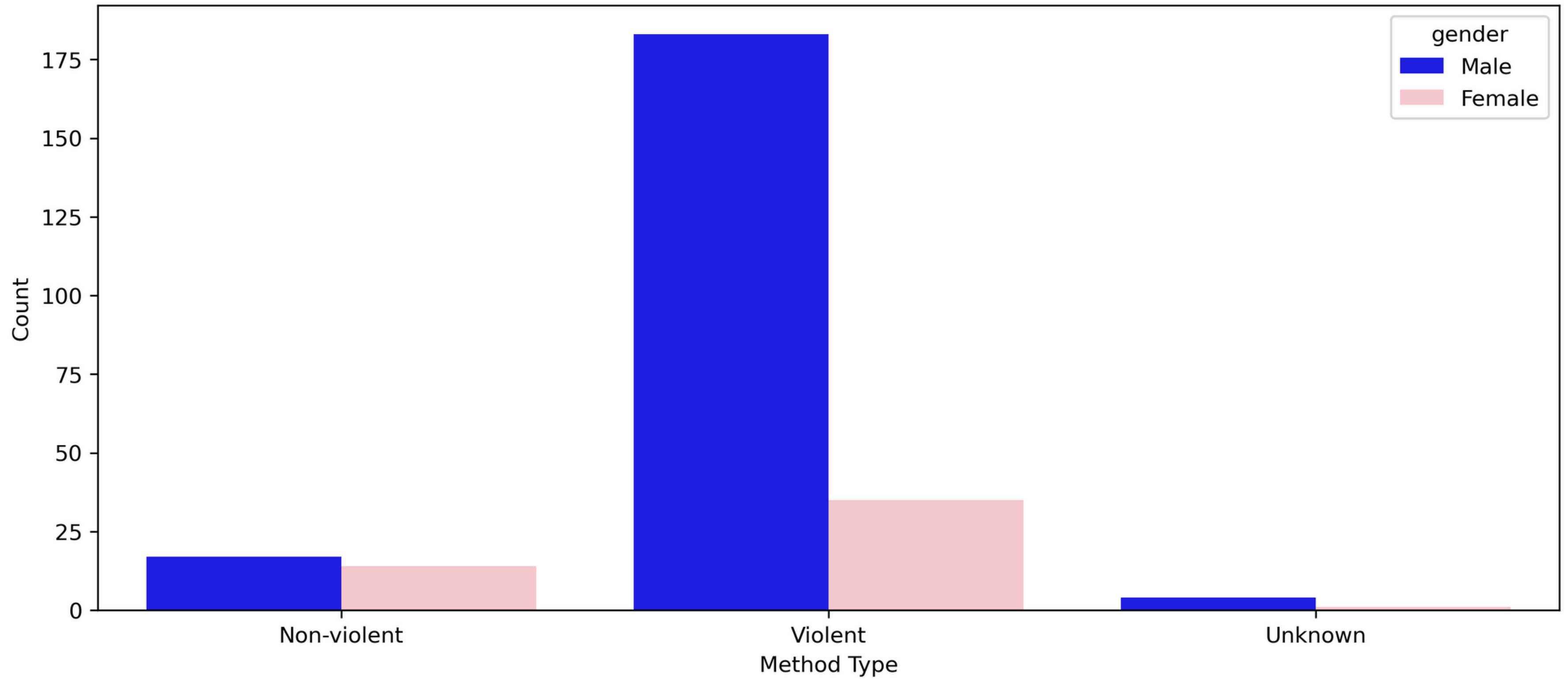
[95]:

	usa_location	gender	method	count
0	Non-USA	Female	Bludgeoning/Beating	4
1	Non-USA	Female	Burning/Fire	1
2	Non-USA	Female	Poisoning	6
3	Non-USA	Female	Shooting	3
4	Non-USA	Female	Stabbing	5
5	Non-USA	Female	Unknown	1
6	Non-USA	Male	Bludgeoning/Beating	6
7	Non-USA	Male	Poisoning	6
8	Non-USA	Male	Shooting	25
9	Non-USA	Male	Stabbing	11
10	Non-USA	Male	Strangulation	6
11	Non-USA	Male	Unknown	2
12	USA	Female	Bludgeoning/Beating	1
13	USA	Female	Poisoning	8
14	USA	Female	Shooting	13
15	USA	Female	Stabbing	6
16	USA	Female	Strangulation	2
17	USA	Male	Bludgeoning/Beating	5
18	USA	Male	Burning/Fire	1
19	USA	Male	Drowning	1
20	USA	Male	Poisoning	11
21	USA	Male	Shooting	95
22	USA	Male	Stabbing	28
23	USA	Male	Strangulation	5
24	USA	Male	Unknown	2

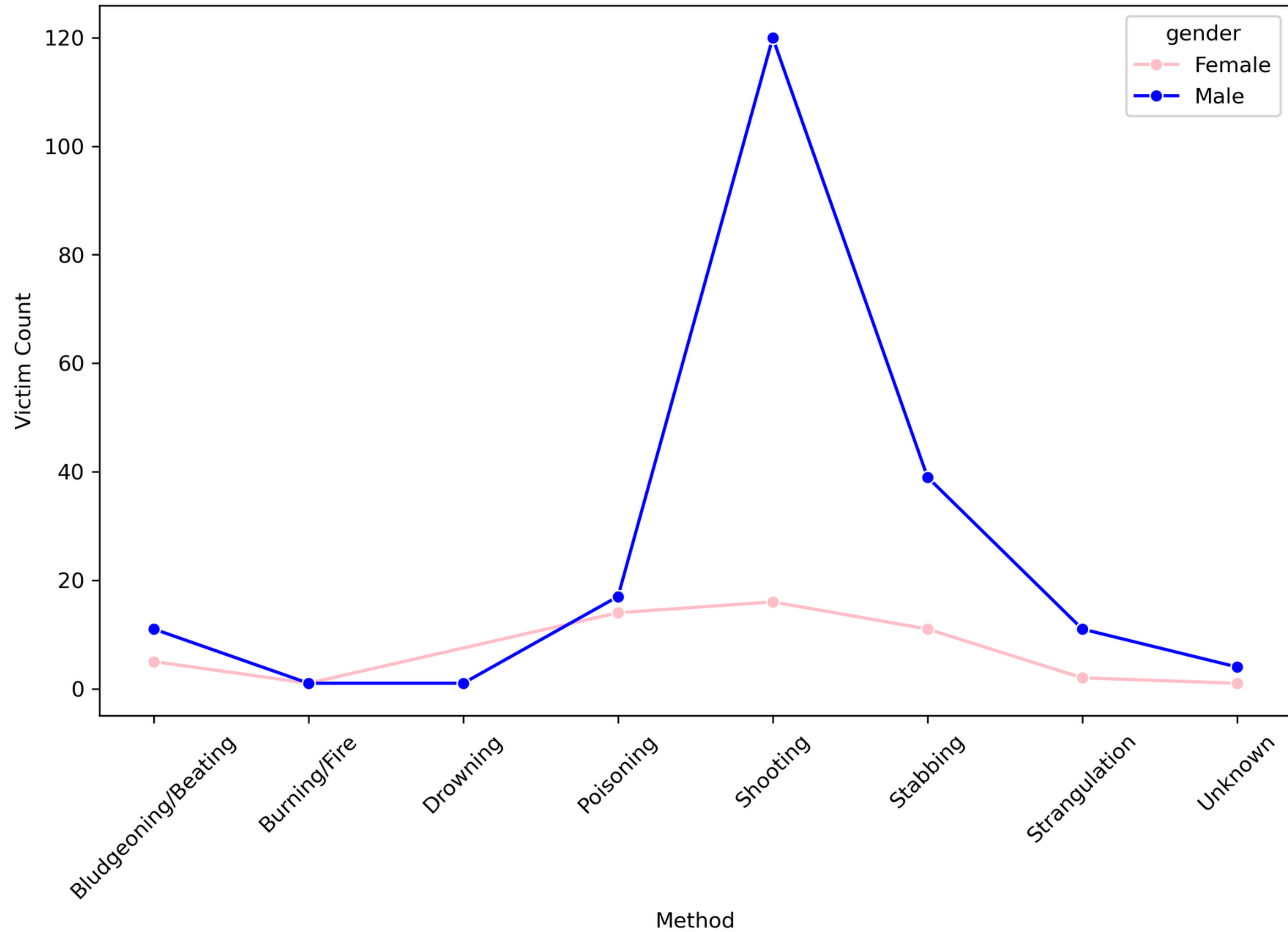
Non-USA Offenders: Violent vs Non-Violent Methods by Gender



USA Offenders: Violent vs Non-Violent Methods by Gender



Method of Killing by Gender



Regression Results			
	Violent (USA)	Violent (Serial Killer)	Shooting (AME)
	(1)	(2)	(3)
Male	0.207** (0.089)	0.205*** (0.068)	0.972*** (0.346)
Serial Killer		0.042 (0.106)	0.415 (0.269)
USA	0.083 (0.099)	0.060 (0.047)	0.962*** (0.293)
Male * USA	-0.028 (0.112)		
Male * Serial Killer		-0.047 (0.116)	
Constant	0.650*** (0.076)	0.651*** (0.064)	-1.507*** (0.388)
Observations	254	254	254
R ²	0.057	0.058	
Adjusted R ²	0.046	0.042	
Log Likelihood			-163.195
Akaike Inf. Crit.			334.390
Residual Std. Error	0.341 (df = 250)	0.342 (df = 249)	
F Statistic	5.051*** (df = 3; 250)	3.801*** (df = 4; 249)	
Note:		*p<0.1; **p<0.05; ***p<0.01	

Thank you!